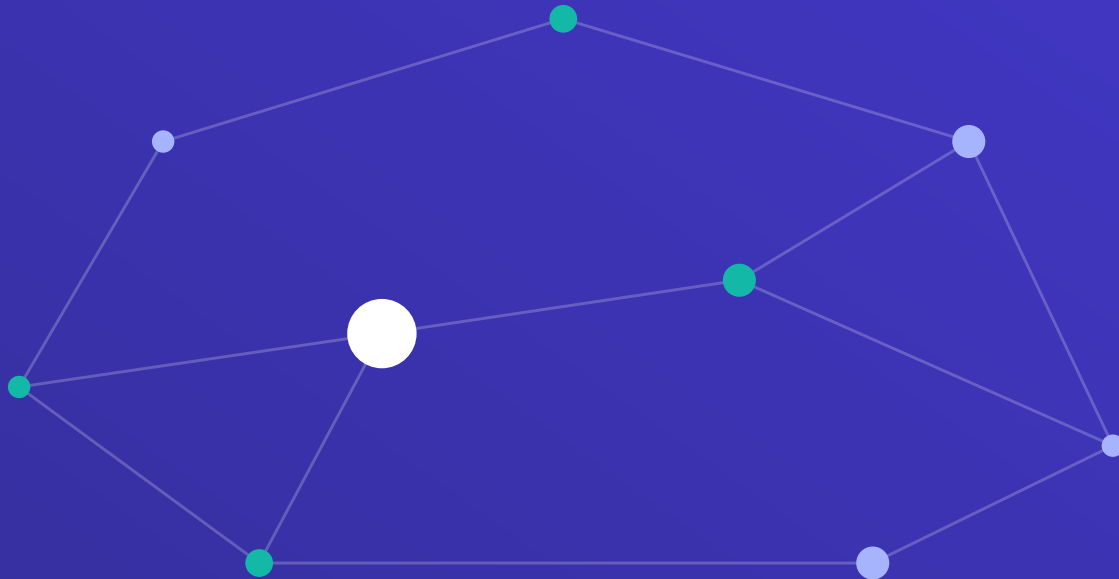




SYNAPSE

MULTI-TENANT SCHOOL MANAGEMENT SAAS

User Guide

End-user documentation for Students, Teachers, Administrators and Super Admins



Version 1.0 · August 2026

Covers the complete SYNAPSE platform — Phases 1-4 and the SaaS upgrade

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1. Welcome to SYNAPSE

SYNAPSE is a production-grade, **multi-tenant** school management platform. Independent schools share one application and one database, while every school's data — students, teachers, classes, subjects, grades, requests, documents, announcements and notifications — stays completely isolated from every other school. Authorization is always enforced on the server: the interface only ever shows what your role is allowed to do.

This guide covers everything an end user can do in SYNAPSE: signing in, working with grades and report cards, timetables, attendance, exams, requests and documents, announcements, subscriptions and billing. Pick the chapter that matches your role and follow it step by step.

What SYNAPSE manages for your school

- **Academic structure** — academic years, semesters, classes and subjects.
- **People** — student and teacher profiles, enrollments and teaching assignments.
- **Grades** — per-subject grade entry on a 0–20 scale, term averages and ranked report cards.
- **Timetables** — a weekly schedule (days 1–5) for every class.
- **Attendance** — daily present / absent / late / excused records per class.
- **Exams** — scheduled exam sessions with date, time and room, plus result compilation.
- **Requests & documents** — certificates, transcripts and recommendation letters with a tracked lifecycle.
- **Announcements & notifications** — targeted school communication with an unread counter.
- **Subscriptions & billing** — plans, usage limits, trials, upgrades and payments.
- **White-label branding** — each school keeps its own name, logo and brand colour.

Who this guide is for

Audience	What they do in SYNAPSE	Start here
Students	Follow their own grades, report card, timetable, attendance, requests, documents and exams.	Chapter 4
Teachers	View their assigned classes, enter grades, take attendance and see scheduled exams.	Chapter 5
School administrators	Run one school: structure, people, timetable, exams, requests, billing and settings.	Chapter 6
Super admins	Run the platform: schools, subscription plans, subscriptions and payments.	Chapter 7

Tip — finding your way around

All screens described here use the same visual language: an indigo sidebar with your role's menu, a top bar with your account and the notification bell, and the main content area. Menu labels in this guide match the sidebar labels exactly.

2. Getting Started

SYNAPSE runs entirely in your web browser — there is nothing to install. This chapter covers accessing the platform, signing in, the demo accounts and demo mode.

2.1 Accessing SYNAPSE

Open the SYNAPSE address in a modern browser (Chrome, Firefox, Edge or Safari). The public landing page introduces the product; from there you can **sign in** to an existing account, or **register a new school** through the onboarding flow (Chapter 11). Each school also has its own branded sign-in page at `/school/<slug>`, which shows the school's logo, name and colours.

When you run SYNAPSE locally for development, the app is served at:

```
http://localhost:5173
```

2.2 Signing in

1. Enter the **email address and password** your school administrator gave you.
2. After a successful login you are redirected automatically to the dashboard that matches your role: `/student`, `/teacher`, `/admin` or `/super-admin`.
3. If the credentials are wrong, an error is shown — contact your school administrator if the problem persists (administrators can reset accounts; passwords are stored as secure hashes, never in plain text).
4. Use the **Sign out** control in the top bar when you are done. Signing out revokes your session token on the server and clears it from the browser.

2.3 Demo accounts

A fresh installation is seeded with demo accounts for every role. All of them use the password `password123`:

Role	Email	School
Super Admin	superadmin@synapse.test	Platform
Administrator	admin@synapse.test	AICS Cameroon
Teacher	teacher@synapse.test	AICS Cameroon
Student	student@synapse.test	AICS Cameroon
Administrator	admin.saintalbert@synapse.test	Saint Albert (trial)
Teacher	teacher.saintalbert@synapse.test	Saint Albert (trial)
Student	student.saintalbert@synapse.test	Saint Albert (trial)
Administrator	admin.demo@synapse.test	Demo Intl (expired)

Demo accounts only

These accounts exist to explore the platform. Change their passwords or remove them before using SYNAPSE with real data.

2.4 Demo mode (without a backend)

If the Laravel backend is not running, the frontend can run in **mock mode**: setting `VITE_USE MOCK=true` in `frontend/.env` installs an in-browser adapter that reproduces the exact API responses of the real backend — including tenant isolation, subscription enforcement and plan limits. Set it to `false` to talk to the real API; no other change is needed.

2.5 Subscription banners

If your school's plan is in a trial, expired or over-limit state, a banner appears at the top of the workspace with the reason and the relevant action (renew, upgrade...). Billing always stays reachable, so a school can renew even when academic features are blocked. See Chapter 10.

3. Roles & Permissions

SYNAPSE has four roles in a strict hierarchy. Every menu, page and API endpoint is guarded by the server, so a user can never see or change data that does not belong to their role — or their school.

Role	Scope	Typical responsibilities
Super Admin	The whole platform	Manages schools (activate / suspend / trial / expire), subscription plans, subscriptions and payments; sees platform-wide statistics.
Administrator	One school	Manages academic years, classes, subjects, students, teachers, teaching assignments, timetables, exams, requests, announcements, billing and school settings.
Teacher	Their own assignments	Sees only the classes and subjects they are assigned to; enters grades, takes attendance and views exams for those classes.
Student	Their own records	Sees their own grades, report card, timetable, attendance, transcript, requests, documents and exams.

- **Tenant isolation** — every tenant-owned record carries the school's identity; queries are scoped automatically, so one school can never read another school's data.
- **Teacher assignments are the source of truth** — a teacher can only view or save grades for a class after an administrator created a teaching assignment (teacher → subject → class → academic year) for them.
- **Students see only their own rows** — grades, documents and notifications are additionally scoped to the signed-in student.
- **Wrong-role access is blocked** — opening another role's page shows an “Access denied” screen instead of data.

4. The Student Guide

As a student you follow your own academic life: grades, report card, timetable, attendance, transcript, exams, requests and documents. Everything you see is yours — other students' data is never visible to you.

4.1 Dashboard

Your home page. It greets you by name and shows the highlights of your school life: summary statistics (subjects, current average and more), today's timetable, and recent announcements targeted at students.

4.2 My Grades

Lists your grades per subject and class, grouped by semester. Grades follow the school's 0–20 scale and the average is computed from the components your teacher has entered (see Chapter 9).

4.3 Report Card

Your official term results: each subject's average, the class average and your **rank** in class. Switch semesters with the tabs at the top.

Feature-dependent menus

The Report Card and Documents menu items only appear when your school's plan enables those features. If you don't see them, the feature is turned off for your school — ask your administrator.

4.4 Timetable

Your weekly schedule as a grid, organised by day (1–5) and period, with the subject and time of each slot.

4.5 Requests

Ask the school for an official document — a **Certificate of Enrollment**, a **Transcript Request**, a **Recommendation Letter** or something else — by submitting a request with a type and a reason. Each request gets a reference number (REQ-...) and a visual stepper that shows its progress: **Submitted** → **Under Review** → **Approved** → **Ready**. When the administrator generates the document, the request becomes **Ready** and you can download it from Documents. If it is rejected, the administrator's note explains why.

4.6 Documents

The official documents generated for your approved requests. Once a document is ready, download it from here.

4.7 Attendance

Your attendance record, date by date. Each day is marked **Present**, **Absent**, **Late** or **Excused** with its status colour.

4.8 Transcript

Your complete academic record across the years you have spent at the school — past enrollments are preserved, so your history is never lost when the school moves to a new academic year.

4.9 Exams

The exam sessions scheduled for your class: subject, date, start and end time, and room. Use it to plan your revision.

4.10 Announcements

All announcements published for students, newest first. Announcements addressed to “all” audiences also appear here.

5. The Teacher Guide

Teachers work only with the classes and subjects the administrator assigned to them. Every list, grade form and attendance roster is filtered by your teaching assignments for the current academic year.

5.1 Dashboard

A summary of your teaching load: your current assignments, upcoming classes and recent activity.

5.2 My Assignments

The list of (subject, class, academic year) combinations you teach. Each assignment opens the class view. If a class is missing, the administrator has not created the teaching assignment yet.

5.3 Grade Entry

- Pick one of your assignments (subject → class) and a semester.
- The roster of that class appears with a score field per student, per grade component — by default **Test 1**, **Test 2** and **Exam** (the school can define its own components with weights, see 6.2).
- Enter scores on the 0–20 scale. The average is computed automatically from the components you filled in.
- Save. The grade is recorded with your identity and the class, subject and academic year — one grade per student, subject, class and year.

Assignment enforcement

Grade access is checked twice: the page only lists assigned classes, and the server refuses any save for a class without a valid teaching assignment. You can never see or edit another teacher's classes.

5.4 Class view & Gradebook

Inside a class you find the student roster and the gradebook: per-student grades across the semester, with averages. Use it to review your class's progress before exams or report cards.

5.5 Attendance

Take attendance for your assigned classes: pick the class and date, then mark each student **Present**, **Absent**, **Late** or **Excused**. The status buttons are colour-coded; unmarked students stay unmarked until you save.

5.6 Exams

The exam sessions scheduled for your subjects and classes: date, time and room, so you always know where you are expected to invigilate.

5.7 Announcements

Announcements addressed to teachers — school-wide messages and everything published for the “teachers” audience.

6. The Administrator Guide

The school administrator runs one school. This chapter walks through every management area, in the order you will typically use them when setting up a school.

6.1 Dashboard

The school at a glance: counts of students, teachers, classes and subjects, plus recent activity across the school.

6.2 Academic Structure

The foundation everything else builds on. Set it up before adding people:

- **Academic years** — create years with start and end dates and mark exactly one as the **current** year. New enrollments and assignments belong to the current year.
- **Semesters** — the school's term structure (2 semesters, 3 terms or 4 quarters). Grades and report cards are grouped by semester.
- **Classes** — the classes of your school (e.g. "Form 1 A").
- **Subjects** — the subjects taught (name and code).
- **Grading components** — define how each subject's average is built: name (e.g. "Assignments"), weight % and optionally a specific subject. The defaults are Test 1, Test 2 and Exam.

6.3 Students

Register students and manage their profiles. A student is a user account plus a school profile; the key action is the **enrollment** (student → class → academic year). One enrollment per student, class and year — and history is preserved, so a student's past classes are never deleted when years change.

6.4 Teachers

Register teachers, then create their **teaching assignments**: teacher → subject → class → academic year. An assignment is what unlocks the class for that teacher — without it they cannot see the class or enter grades. One assignment per (teacher, subject, class, year) combination.

6.5 Timetable

Build the weekly timetable per class: pick a class and academic year, then place subjects on days 1–5 with start and end times. The edit view lets you add, move or remove slots; students and teachers see the result in their timetables immediately.

6.6 Attendance

The school-wide attendance view: pick a class and date to see and edit the roster's statuses (Present, Absent, Late, Excused), with a live count of each status.

6.7 Exams

- **Schedule** — create exam sessions: class, subject, semester, date, start and end time, and room. Sessions appear in the exam timetable and can be removed again.
- **Result compilation** — rank students by term average per class and subject to prepare report cards and merit lists.

6.8 Bulk Import

Add many students or teachers at once from a CSV file:

1. Choose the import type (students or teachers) and download the CSV template.
2. Fill the template — columns are **name**, **email** and the fields shown in the template.
3. Upload the file. SYNAPSE validates every row and reports parse or validation errors before anything is created.

6.9 Requests

The school's request queue. Administrators drive every transition of the lifecycle:

You see...	Action	Result
A request in Submitted state	Start the review	Status becomes Under Review ; the student is notified.
A request Under Review	Approve or reject (with a note)	Approved → Approved . Rejected → Rejected ; the student sees your note.
An Approved request	Generate document	The official document is created, the status becomes Ready and the student can download it.

6.10 Announcements

Publish announcements to your school with an audience: **everyone**, **students only** or **teachers only**. Publishing notifies the right users instantly; each audience only ever sees announcements meant for it.

6.11 Billing

Your school's subscription, in one page:

- **Current plan** — plan name, status (trial / active / expired / ...) and the next renewal or trial-end date.
- **Usage vs limits** — progress bars for students, teachers and classes against your plan's limits.
- **Renew** — renew the current plan (mock payment in development).
- **Available plans** — upgrade at any time; limits take effect immediately.
- **Payment history** — every payment for the school.

How limits work

Plan limits are enforced on the server: when the school reaches its student, teacher or class limit, the API rejects further creation with a clear “upgrade required” message, and the banner on top of the workspace shows the same information.

6.12 Settings

School settings, grouped in two cards:

- **Branding** — school logo, school name and brand colour, plus a switch to enable custom branding on the school's portal and sign-in pages.

- **Academics** — grading scale, semester structure (2 semesters / 3 terms / 4 quarters) and timezone.

7. The Super Admin Guide

The Super Admin runs the SYNAPSE platform itself — not a single school. This chapter covers the platform dashboard, school management, plans, subscriptions and payments.

7.1 Platform Dashboard

Platform-wide statistics: total schools, total users, students and active subscriptions, the distribution of schools across plans, and the breakdown of school statuses (**Active**, **Trial**, **Suspended**, **Expired**).

7.2 Schools

Create tenant schools (name, slug, email, phone) or open a school's detail page. From the detail page you control the school's status — **activate**, **suspend**, put it back on **trial** or **expire** it — and inspect its users and subscription. Suspended or expired schools are blocked from academic operations but can still reach billing to renew.

7.3 Subscription Plans

Plans are fully configurable — never hard-coded. Each plan has a name, slug, price, billing interval (monthly/yearly), currency and limits (maximum students, teachers, classes). Plans also carry **features** that gate functionality per school (e.g. report cards, document management).

Plans apply immediately

Changing a plan's limits or features affects every school on that plan immediately — both the interface and the server-side enforcement read the current plan.

7.4 Subscriptions

Every subscription across the platform, per school: plan, status (**trial**, **active**, **past_due**, **cancelled**, **expired**, **suspended**), dates and amounts. Use it to audit revenue (MRR) and plan adoption.

7.5 Payments

The platform-wide payment ledger: every payment with its school, subscription, amount, gateway and status. Development payments are flagged as sandbox and are never counted as production revenue.

8. Requests & Documents — End to End

This chapter follows one request through the whole lifecycle, so both students and administrators know exactly what happens at each step.

Step	Who acts	What happens
1 — Submitted	Student	The student creates a request (type + reason). It gets a REQ-... reference, the status is submitted , and the school's administrators are notified.
2 — Under Review	Administrator	The administrator starts the review: status becomes under_review ; the student is notified.
3 — Approved	Administrator	The administrator approves (or rejects with a note). Approved notifies the student; Rejected ends the lifecycle with the note attached.
4 — Ready	Administrator	For an approved request, the administrator generates the official document. The status becomes ready , the student is notified, and the document appears in the student's Documents page for download.

On the student's side, a visual stepper (Submitted → Under Review → Approved → Ready) shows exactly where the request stands at any moment.

9. Grades & the Grading Model

Grades in SYNAPSE follow a simple, auditable model on the school's 0-20 scale. Understanding it makes grade entry and report cards predictable.

- **One grade per (student, subject, class, academic year)** — grades never overwrite history across years.
- **Components** — a grade is built from components; by default **Test 1**, **Test 2** and **Exam**. The school can define its own components with weights (6.2).
- **Average** — the mean of the components that have been entered, rounded to two decimals. Empty fields are ignored, so you can save partial grades.
- **Who entered it** — every grade records the teacher who entered it, alongside class, subject and year.
- **Report cards** — term averages per subject, the class average, and the student's rank in class.

Average (0-20)	Meaning in the UI
16 and above	Shown green — excellent result
12 to 15.9	Shown blue — good result
Below 12	Shown amber — needs improvement

9.1 Who can enter grades

Only a teacher with a valid teaching assignment for that subject, class and academic year. The check is enforced in the backend on every save — even if the page were bypassed, the API would refuse.

10. Subscriptions & Billing

Every school runs on a subscription plan. This chapter explains plans, trials, limits, enforcement and payments.

Plans and trials

- **Plans** define price, interval, currency, limits and features; the super admin configures them (7.3).
- **Trials** — every new school starts on a free trial (configurable, 14 days by default).
- **Status** — a subscription can be trial, active, past_due, cancelled, expired or suspended; the school's status mirrors its subscription health.

Enforcement

- **Limits** — creating students, teachers or classes beyond the plan's limit returns a clear “upgrade required” error.
- **Academic block** — expired or suspended schools are blocked from academic operations, but **billing stays reachable** so they can renew.
- **Features** — plan features gate both the menus (report cards, documents) and the underlying API.

Payments (Cameroon-first)

Payments go through a provider abstraction with four gateways: **Mock** (development only — always marked sandbox), **MTN Mobile Money**, **Orange Money** and **Card**. Real gateways refuse to charge until genuine credentials are configured, so no fake production payments can ever occur.

11. Onboarding a New School

A new school joins SYNAPSE through a public four-step onboarding wizard. This chapter describes the wizard and the administrator's first-day checklist.

Step	What you provide
1 — School information	School name, URL slug, email, phone and address.
2 — Administrator account	The first administrator's name, email and password (at least 8 characters).
3 — Plan	Pick a subscription plan; the wizard shows what each plan includes.
4 — Free trial	The school starts on its free trial and the administrator signs in to set everything up.

First-day checklist for the new administrator

- Open **Academic Structure** (6.2) and create the current academic year, semesters, classes and subjects.
- Add students and teachers — individually (6.3, 6.4) or via CSV import (6.8).
- Create **teaching assignments** so teachers can access their classes (6.4).
- Build the **timetable** (6.5) and check it from a student and teacher account.
- Review **Settings** (6.12): grading scale, semester structure, timezone and branding.

- Publish a welcome **announcement** (6.10) so users see the notification system working.

12. Announcements & Notifications

Communication is built into every workflow: whenever something happens that concerns you, SYNAPSE notifies you.

- **Announcements** are published by administrators with an audience: everyone, students or teachers. Each audience only sees what is meant for them.
- **Notifications** are personal: the bell in the top bar shows your unread count; open it to read and act on each notification or mark all as read.
- **Events that notify** — a request submitted, a request status change, a document ready for download, and every published announcement.

13. Privacy & Data Isolation

SYNAPSE is multi-tenant by design. Schools share the application, but nothing leaks between them.

- **School isolation** — every tenant-owned record is tied to its school and every query is scoped automatically; a user of school A can never read school B's data, by accident or on purpose.
- **Role isolation** — the hierarchy super admin → administrator → teacher → student strictly limits what each role can do (Chapter 3).
- **Personal isolation** — students only ever see their own grades, documents and notifications; teachers only their assigned classes.
- **Audit trails** — school, onboarding, subscription and payment events are recorded in audit logs for accountability.
- **Secure by default** — passwords are stored as hashes, sessions use revocable tokens, and payments are sandboxed until real credentials are configured.

14. Troubleshooting & FAQ

I signed in but landed on the wrong page

You are redirected to your role's dashboard. If that role is wrong (for example you are a teacher but land on the student dashboard), ask your administrator or super admin to correct your account.

I see “Access denied” (403)

You opened a page that belongs to another role. Use the sidebar links of your own role — for example, teachers use [/teacher/...](#) pages, never [/admin/...](#) pages.

A teacher cannot see a class they teach

The administrator must create a **teaching assignment** (teacher → subject → class → academic year) for the current academic year. Without it the class will not appear for the teacher (6.4).

“Upgrade required” when adding students or teachers

The school has reached its plan's limit. The administrator can upgrade in **Billing** (6.11); limits take effect immediately.

A banner says the subscription has expired

Academic operations are blocked for expired or suspended schools, but billing remains reachable: the administrator renews in **Billing** (6.11) and everything unlocks again.

The Report Card or Documents menu is missing

Those menus are feature-gated by the school's plan. If the plan does not include them, they are hidden — and the API refuses them too (10).

Grades, timetable or attendance look empty

Most pages follow the current academic year and semester. Check the selected year/semester, and that the administrator has created the structure, enrollments and assignments (6.2–6.5).

I forgot my password

Contact your school administrator (students, teachers) or the platform super admin (administrators) to reset your account. Passwords are stored as secure hashes and can never be recovered in plain text.

Is this the real data or the demo?

If the frontend runs with `VITE_USE MOCK=true` you are in mock mode (2.4): an in-browser adapter replays realistic responses without a backend. Set it to `false` and start the Laravel API to work with real data.

15. Quick Reference

Dashboards by role

Role	Dashboard path
Super Admin	/super-admin
Administrator	/admin
Teacher	/teacher
Student	/student

Key terminology

Term	Meaning
School status	active · trial · suspended · expired
Subscription status	trial · active · past_due · cancelled · expired · suspended
Request status	submitted → under_review → approved → ready (or rejected)
Attendance status	present · absent · late · excused
Grading scale	0–20; averages are the mean of entered components
Teaching assignment	teacher → subject → class → academic year; unlocks grade entry
Enrollment	student → class → academic year; preserved across years

Version note

This guide mirrors the SYNAPSE interface. If a screen differs from what you see, you are likely running a different version — check the changelog or ask your administrator.